

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major suit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

- 4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

- 3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

- 3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

- 3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

- 4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦A

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥6

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥2

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦9

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 5 4 2

♥ 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ J 10 8 5 4

♠ K Q

♥ A J 10 9 7 6

♦ 9 7

♣ A 9 6



♠ 10 7 6

♥ 5

♦ Q J 10 6 5 3

♣ K Q 3

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ A K 4

♣ 7 2

NORTH's 3♥ bid shows extra strength and a 6-trump hand.

The next three bids are all Control-showing cue bids.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 6 3
♥ J 8 3
♦ K Q
♣ A K 8 3

♠ J 2

♥ 10 9 6 2

♦ 7 5 4 3

♣ 7 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 9 8 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 9 8

♣ Q J 2

♠ 10 5

♥ Q 7 5

♦ A J 10 6 2

♣ 10 9 6

EAST shows extra strength / five trumps. 4♣ and 4♥ are Control-showing bids.

WEST knows they are missing the ♦ A, she uses Blackwood just to make certain EAST holds the trump Ace.

West	North	East	South
		1♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by East			
Lead: ♦ A			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 10 6 5

♥ 7 6

♦ K 8 7 5

♣ A 3 2

♠ 3

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 9 4



♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ 10 2

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 10 8 7

♠ K Q J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ 9 4

♣ J 6 5

NORTH's 3♠ bid, a double-jump, is a Splinter bid. It shows game-forcing strength, at least four cards in partner's suit, and a singleton or void in the Splintered suit.

SOUTH has just 14 points and the ♠ shortness in NORTH's hand doesn't improve her hand since she had just one ♠ loser anyway. She signs off in 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

Pass

1♥

All Pass

4♥

4♥ by South

Lead: ♥6

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 6 4
 ♥ K Q J 8 4
 ♦ K 4
 ♣ A 6 5

♠ K 10 9 8 2

♥ 6 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 10 2



♠ 3

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 9 4

♠ A Q J 5

♥ 10 7

♦ 9 6 5 3

♣ 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♥2			

This is a companion hand to Deal 13.

WEST has 14 points, the same strength she had in Deal 13. But what a difference. This time EAST's ♠ shortness complements her hand very well. She bids 4♣ to show her Control, and after EAST shows the ♦ A she uses Blackwood to make sure EAST also has the trump Ace.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 2
 ♥ 9 4
 ♦ A K Q 10 6
 ♣ 8 7 4

♠ A 7 5
 ♥ Q J 10 7 6
 ♦ J 8
 ♣ K Q 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 6 4 3
 ♥ 5 3 2
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ A 9 2

♠ K Q
 ♥ A K 8
 ♦ 7 5 4 3
 ♣ J 10 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♦9			

SOUTH has 13 points and good 3-card support for NORTH's 1♥ opening bid. But he should not bid 2NT since that bid promises 4+ cards in support. South must still insure they reach game, so he bids a forcing 2♣.

When NORTH next says 2NT SOUTH can jump to 4♥.

NOTE: if you used Jacoby 2NT and reached the 4♥ game, give yourself credit anyway.